1.1 Preliminary insight

In 'The Little Prince' Antoine de Saint-Exupéry shows he thinks like a good engineer, with the same kind of foundational abstractions that Linux, HTTP or Erlang are based on, when he envisions tiny planets with one occupant each, for whom everybody else is of the same type. On the asteroid 325 there is only a king, and to this king, everybody else is a subject: "«Ah! Here is a subject,» exclaimed the king, when he saw the little prince coming"

In Linux, or rather, from the point of view of Linux, everything is a file: folders are files that list other files, programs are executable files, and hardware devices are files that you can read from and write to. In HTTP, everything is a resource that you GET, POST, DELETE and so on; and in Erlang, the programming language of choice for scalable concurrency, everything is a process (just like you will be, if you ever join a Hoapa protocol).

The little prince visits several of those population-one celestial objects, and one of them is very close in spirit to Hoapa protocols: asteroid 330, whose lone resident is a geographer. Both have the same task: to chart their world, and the same inputs: explorers. And both will produce "voluminous books", except the Hoapa ones will welcome a lot more diversity and complexity while being a lot more accessible and pedagogical than the old fashioned atlases.

The little prince is surprised to see his geographer doesn't know anything about the planet he inhabits:

> "Exactly," the geographer said. "But I am not an explorer. I haven't a single explorer on my planet. It is not the geographer who goes out to count the towns, the rivers, the mountains, the seas, the oceans, and the deserts. The geographer is much too important to go loafing about. He does not leave his desk. But he receives the explorers in his study. He asks them questions, and he notes down what they recall of their travels. And if the recollections of any one among them seem interesting to him, the geographer orders an inquiry into that explorer's moral character."

Hoapa protocols are in this precise state at the moment: (almost) ready to do their work, but they have no input to work with. They're waiting.

The sense of my work is twofold:

- Making the system fully ready to accept its first explorers (the implementation)
- Making the system legitimate enough to motivate participation (the theory)

Hoapa protocols are computer programs that emulate the geographer, and aren't restricted to geography. They're interested in whatever the explorers want to talk about.
The legitimacy comes from the minimalist -- separations of concern.

-> separations of concern: "external" - protocol (dirty work) | reality (freedom to explore) ; "internal" - unityped agents | typed documentation (only ideas get "put in boxes", not people)

, but also a crucial difference between how the two systems seek veracity:

- The geographer "looks back" when presented a new information: he orders an inquiry into the life of the explorer, and will later demand proofs of the thing they propose

- Hoapa "plays forward" and take any new information without judgement, to make it enter an evolutionary game with the rest of the information pool, where randomly selected explorers are the referees

This evolutionary game is also like Linux or HTTP, and to it "everything is a conversation", where the conversations are shaped exactly like the citizen assemblies/conventions of participative democracy (select a few random citizens, give them ample time and resources to study their topic, let them write a document of their findings by consensus, take their work seriously). A strategy that is battle tested and has shown time and time again how "regular people" perform extremely well when put in the right context.

, whose success has been credited to a "universal sense of ethics", which is because this work is about attachment
-> theory of attachment, how the protocol eventually produces mature nodes to act as secure bases for further exploration

---

Please read all top level files in /workflow. Next we'll discuss what should be done next, following what has been said in the next step section in status.md (we is me the instigator, you Claude and another agent, Codex, who will see your output and whose output you'll see, through me copy and pasting it). You write the code and Codex's in charge of the workflow files updates.

Please read all top level files in /workflow. Next we'll discuss what should be done next, following what has been said in the next step section in status.md (we is me the instigator, you Codex and another agent, Claude, who will see your ouput and whose output you'll see, through me copy and pasting it). Claude writes the code and you're in charge of the workflow files updates.